

For software that installs and does not run, right-click the shortcut of the installed application and click 'Properties'. In the next screen, you will see a tab called 'Compatibility', which was especially incorporated in Windows XP to make it compatible with older software. Here you will find a host of options-making the software run in an environment that emulates as if the OS is Windows 95/98/ME, and you will need to check if the software runs fine. If it does, your job is done. If not, try checking the boxes under the Display settings and Input settings options, and see if the software runs fine.

Microsoft has released Service Packs for Windows XP, which not only offer updates, patches and other OS enhancements in one big pack but also take care of compatibility issues of hardware and software. Some software depend on other Microsoft products such as the .Net Framework, to install and function properly in Windows XP. For instance, the latest ATi drivers need .Net to be installed first before you install the drivers in the system. As a rule of thumb, it's better to check the software requirements before installation. Older software may or may not install, but if you are using really archaic software, you would be better off without it.

Troubleshooting And Fixing Windows XP

Finally, it's time for troubleshooting Windows XP. There can be a million different issues in different computers mostly caused by the installed software and hardware.

We cannot and for that matter not even Microsoft can list all the software and hardware issues that may occur after installing the OS. Below, we have tackled FAQs that users across the world face regularly.

1. How can I increase performance with Windows XP?

Solution: It's true that Windows XP does take up a lot of resources. Try the following steps.